

A MANICHAEAN MIDDLE PERSIAN TEXT

(Mani's last audience)



Introduction

Mani was an Iranian prophet who lived between 216 and 274 CE. He founded the Manichaeism, a very widespread religion of late antiquity, from Africa, Syria, Mesopotamia to central Asia and China.

General remarks

This manuscript is a part of Turfan collection, which comprises a large number of documents dated between the 3rd and 7th century CE. Unfortunately the text is incomplete, the ending page is lost and some words have been reconstructed because were partially erased.

This text describes the Mani's audience with Bahram I, a Sasanian king who imprisoned and tortured Mani, until he died.

Text (read from right to left)

1) የሰላም ጥሪ ስለ የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ
የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ
የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ

2) የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ

3) የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ

4) የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ

.. የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ

5) የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ

የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ

.. የሰላም ጥሪ

6) የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ

.. የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ

.. የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ

7) የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ

8) የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ

የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ የሰላም ጥሪ

.. ຜາ ສາມາດ ນ ສິນ ຕາມ
ເກົ່າ ສາມາດ ສາມາດ ນ ສິນ ຕາມ ຜາ ນາມ 9)

.. ຄຳ ສອບ ນ ສິນ
ຜາ ນ ສິນ ສາມາດ ສາມາດ ຜາ ນາມ 10)
... ສາມາດ ຜາ ນາມ ນ

.. ຄຳ ສອບ ຜາ ນ ສິນ ສາມາດ ຜາ ນາມ 11)

.. ຄຳ ສອບ ຜາ ນ ສິນ ສາມາດ ຜາ ນາມ

ເກົ່າ ສາມາດ ສາມາດ ນ ຜາ ນາມ 12)

ນ ຜາ ນ ສິນ .. ຜາ ສາມາດ ຜາ ນ ຜາ ນ 13)

.. ຜາ ສາມາດ ຜາ ນ ຜາ ສາມາດ ຜາ ນ

ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ ສາມາດ ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ

.. ຜາ ສາມາດ ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ

.. ຜາ ສາມາດ ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ 14)

ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ 15)

.. ຜາ ສາມາດ ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ

ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ ຜາ 16)

.. ከታሪክ ላይ ከሰላም

ጥንታዊው ህግ የሆነው የሰላም ህግ 17)

.. የሰላም ህግ የሆነው የሰላም ህግ

ህግ ህግ .. የሰላም ህግ 18)

.. የሰላም ህግ የሆነው የሰላም ህግ

የሰላም ህግ የሆነው የሰላም ህግ 19)

.. የሰላም ህግ የሆነው የሰላም ህግ

ህግ የሰላም ህግ የሆነው የሰላም ህግ 20)

... ከሰላም ህግ

Pronunciation and translation

- 1) (mānī)..... āmad, ka-š an nūhzādag īg tarkumān ud kuštaih dxīr ud abzaxyā ī pārsīg amwašt būd hēm °
(Mani).....came, when he had gathered me, the interpreter Nōhzādag and Kuštay d(h)r and the persian Abzaxyā.
- 2) ud šāh nān xwardan bazm bud °
And the king sat at the table.
- 3) u-š dast ahanūn-iz nē šust
And he hadn't washed his hands yet.
- 4) ud adīd hēnd pasānīgān, u-šān guft: kū mānī āmad, ud pad dar ēstēd °°
And the servants came in and said: Mani has come and is standing at the door.
- 5) ud šāh ō xwadāwan paygām frēstād: kū ēw zamān pāy, dā an xwad ō tō āyān °°
And the king sent a message to the lord (Mani): 'Wait a while until I come to you'.
- 6) ud xwadāwan abāz ō ēw kustag īg wēnag nišast °° dā šāh dast šust °°
čē xwad-iz ō nahčīhr franaftan būd °°
And the lord sat at one of the watchmen's seats, until the king had washed his hands, for he had gone hunting.
- 7) ud az xwaran ul āxist
And he rose from the meal.
- 8) u-š dast ēw abar sagān bāmbišn abgand °° ud yak abar kirdēr ī ardawānagān, ud frāz ō xwadāwan āmad °°
And he laid one hand on the queen of Sag, and one hand on Kediri the Ardawan, and came before the lord (Mani).
- 9) u-š pad sar saxwan ō xwadāwan ōh guft: kū mā drīst awar! °°
And addressing to the lord he said like this: 'you are not welcome!'
- 10) u-š xwadāwan abāz guft: kū čim rāy, tis-om winast? °°
And the lord said back: 'for what reason, what have I done wrong?'
- 11) ud šāh guft: kū-m sōgand xward °° kū-t pad ēn zamīg nē hilān raft °°
And the king said: 'I have sworn not to let you enter this earth'.
- 13) kū ay pad čē abāyišn hēd °° ka nē ō kārezār šawēd, ud nē nahčīhr kunēd °° ba ōhāy ēn bišehkīh rāy ud ēn darmān burdan rāy abāyišn hēd °°
'Oh, what use are you if you do not go on campaigns and do not hunt, but only be useful for this art of healing and for bringing medicine?'

- 14) ud ēn-iz nē kunēd °°
'And you don't even do that!'.
15) u-š xwadāwan passox ōh dād: kū man pad ašmāh tis-oz nē winast °°
And the lord answered him: 'I have done nothing to you!'.
16) čē-m mēšag kirbagī kird pad ašmāh u-tān pad tōhmagān °°
'For I have always done good to you and your relatives!'.
17) ud was ud frahīd bannag ī ašmāh, kē-m dēw ud druxš az-iš ba burd °°
'And many and more are your servants from whom I banished demons and spirits.
18) ud was būd hēnd °° kē-m az wēmārīh āxēzenād hēnd °°
'And there were many whom I freed from illness'
19) ud was būd hēnd, kē-m tab ud rarz ī čand-sārag az-iš ānāft °°
'And there were many from whom I took away all kinds of fevers and tremors'
20) ud was būd hēnd, kē ō marg mad, u-m-išān °°°
'And there were many who were near to death, and I.....them